Conversation track 22, 24, 25

Miranda, from Chicago, has just started work in Sydney. Nathan is her new colleague.

Miranda: Okay, translate for me. My boss said she'd see me this arvo. Should I be worried?

Nathan: Relax, it just means afternoon. Speaking of which, **barbie** at mine Sunday **arvo**?

Miranda: I'd love to! Should I bring anything?

Nathan: Just bring a plate. There'll be **heaps** of food.

Miranda: A plate? You guys don't own dishes?

Nathan: No, a plate of food! A salad or something. And wear your **thongs**.

Miranda: Excuse me? Back home, thongs are underwear!

Nathan: Flip-flops! I meant flip-flops! Okay, you'll need a **fortnight** to get the hang of this.

Miranda: A fortnight? You sound like my British grandma.

Nathan: Two weeks, then. See? You're learning heaps already.

Speak Like a Native track 23

1. Speaking of which, barbie at mine Sunday arvo?

linking: "Speaking‿of"
strong: "barbie", "Sunday arvo"

Giọng Úc không đọc /r/: "barbie" → "ba-bi", "arvo" → "a-vâu". Câu hỏi rút gọn (bỏ "Do you want to come to a…"), lên giọng ở cuối.

2. Excuse me? Back home, thongs are underwear!

linking: "thongs‿are"
strong: "Excuse me", "underwear"

Lên giọng thật cao ở "Excuse me?" vì sốc. Giọng Mỹ đọc rõ /r/: "underwear" → "ăn-đơr-wer".

3. Okay, you'll need a fortnight to get the hang of this.

change: "get the" (t gần như mất)
linking: "hang‿of"
strong: "fortnight", "hang"

"fortnight" = hai tuần, giọng Úc đọc "fo-t-nait", không có /r/. "hang of this" đọc liền: "hang-ơv-đhis".

• Từ rút gọn đuôi -ie, -o nhấn âm đầu: BREK-kie, BAR-bie, AR-vo.
• Giọng Úc không đọc /r/ cuối âm tiết (arvo, barbie, fortnight); giọng Mỹ đọc rõ (underwear).
• Giọng Úc thường đọc /eɪ/ gần "ai": plate → "plai-t", mate → "mai-t".
• Câu hỏi lặp lại lời người kia (A plate? A fortnight?) lên giọng ở cuối để tỏ ý ngạc nhiên.

Role Play track 27

A: Okay, translate for me. My boss said she'd see me this arvo. Should I be worried?

B: Relax, it just means afternoon. Speaking of which, barbie at mine _____?

A: I'd love to! Should I bring anything?

B: Just bring a plate. There'll be heaps of food.

A: A plate? You guys don't own dishes?

B: No, a plate of food! A salad or something. And wear _____.

A: Excuse me? Back home, thongs are underwear!

B: Flip-flops! I meant flip-flops! Okay, you'll need a fortnight to get the hang of this.

A: A fortnight? You sound like my British grandma.

B: Two weeks, then. See? You're learning _____ already.

Study Notes

Just bring a plate.
Cứ mang theo một đĩa đồ ăn là được.
Ở Úc, "bring a plate" = mang một món ăn đến tiệc để mọi người cùng ăn, không phải mang đĩa không!
Cách nói tương đương: Bring something to share.

You'll need a fortnight to get the hang of this.
Bạn sẽ cần hai tuần mới quen được đấy.
"fortnight" (Anh, Úc) = hai tuần; người Mỹ gần như không dùng. "get the hang of something" = quen tay, nắm được cách làm.
Cách nói tương đương: It'll take you two weeks to get used to it.

Grammar Focus

Từ rút gọn kiểu Úc: thêm -ie / -o

Người Úc hay cắt ngắn từ rồi thêm -ie hoặc -o: afternoon → arvo, breakfast → brekkie, barbecue → barbie, sunglasses → sunnies.

Let's grab **brekkie** at the beach.
See you this **arvo**!
Don't forget your **sunnies**.

Cùng nghĩa, khác từ: Úc / Anh / Mỹ

heaps (Úc) = loads (Anh) = a ton (Mỹ): rất nhiều. fortnight (Anh, Úc) = two weeks. thongs (Úc) = flip-flops (Mỹ, Anh).

We've got **heaps** of time.
I'm off for a **fortnight** in June.
Grab your **thongs**. We're off to the beach.

Substitution Drill track 28

1. Speaking of which, barbie at mine Sunday arvo?
   a. this arvo
   b. after work
   c. on the weekend

2. And wear your thongs.
   a. your sunnies
   b. a hat
   c. sunscreen

3. You're learning heaps already.
   a. loads
   b. a ton
   c. so much